

Creating implementation intentions are effective in helping to achieve goals in the face of obstacles. Take some time to develop an implementation intention to help stay focused on reaching a goal.

STEP 1	Choose a goal that you would like to work on.
STEP 2	Next, think about all the possible ways you could achieve your goal, the obstacles that may get in the way, and the situational cues that would trigger the plan.
STEP 3	Using these ideas, create the 'if' part by writing the specific situational cue you would use to enact the plan. The cue could be internal such as a feeling (e.g., stressed, sad, etc.) or external such as a place, person, or point of time (e.g., at a party, in the evening, etc.). For example: • <i>If I am feeling stressed after work and want to eat chocolate....</i> • <i>If it is 3pm and I want a snack....</i> • <i>If I am at the gym...</i>
STEP 4	Create the 'then' part by writing a specific statement about the time, place, and action you will take in response to the situational cue (if statement). The action could include a behavior or a thought. For example: • <i>If I am feeling stressed after work and want to eat chocolate, THEN I will make a fruit salad!</i> • <i>If it is 3pm and I want a snack, THEN I will go for a walk first!</i> • <i>If I am at the gym, THEN I will tell myself I am strong!</i>
STEP 5	Read the entire if-then plan back to yourself at least three times. By the final time, you should be able to say the plan correctly without looking at the written statement.
Initiating a CHANGE List your implementation goal to kickstart a new habit. If CUE, then I will do ROUTINE (Behavior) to get a REWARD.	
Cue	"If
Routine	"Then I will do
Reward	"In order to get a